

COINPICKS · RESEARCH & EDUCATION

Master Direction Report

Five Pillars, One Table, One Number — Updated & Re-verified September 26, 2026 (FULL WEEKLY refresh) · DRAFT — AWAITING MY STAMP

This is a **FULL WEEKLY refresh** (score set **2026-09-26_draft, DRAFT — not stamped**) against the Sept 23 committed baseline (2026-09-23_draft). Four independent primary-source research passes, one per pillar, followed by **two adversarial-verification passes that re-derived every load-bearing new claim from primary sources rather than from the research's own citations** — and which overturned findings in both directions. **Fed & Macro RE-RATED DOWN** (31/29/37/44/58 → 27/25/34/43/58) on a week of hawkish evidence: Governor Barr's Sept 23 speech, verbatim from the Fed's own PDF, putting further tightening in his stated base case; the S&P Global flash PMI's fastest input-cost inflation since October 2022; UMich long-run inflation expectations breaking a three-month plateau; and an \$83.6B one-week reserve drain on the Fed's own H.4.1. **Iran War Risk RE-RATED as a window split** (3/3/16/35/66 → 2/5/18/36/66): Iran's foreign minister put a concrete seven-day Hormuz-reopening plan on the record Sept 25, and the Nov 3 midterms fall outside the 1mo window but inside 3mo and 6mo. **Tokenization CUT one point on 1mo** (58/65/70/77/86 → 57/65/70/77/86) — reversing the abandoned Sept 24 draft, because this pillar's own pre-committed trigger fired DOWNWARD: tokenized Treasuries -6.95% over 30 days, a third consecutive negative print. **CLARITY Act held flat**, but with four factual corrections to its record, including one where the report stated the opposite of a primary source. **Bitcoin TA (computed) ticked** as BTC eased to \$83,918.52 from \$85,488.24. **This cycle also supersedes an interrupted Sept 24 cycle** that was never rendered, archived or committed, yet whose report edits asserted a stamp that was never written — see What Changed for the audit trail.

THE FINAL NUMBER · SEPTEMBER 26, 2026 · EQUAL-WEIGHT MODEL (DRAFT — AWAITING ALEX'S STAMP)

-0.04

Neutral overall — -0.04, versus +0.02 on the Sept 23 committed baseline. The headline call band holds Neutral, and the horizon-weighted variant holds Mild Bull at +0.51 versus +0.55. Equal-weight mean of the five master window signals (scale -10 to +10). **Three qualitative pillars moved and they largely offset** — Fed & Macro cut four points on 1mo/3mo and three on 6mo; Iran War Risk split, one point down on 1mo against two up on each of 3mo and

6mo; Tokenization cut one point on 1mo; CLARITY Act held flat; Bitcoin TA (computed) ticked with a lower BTC price. **Two call bands flipped:** 3 months went Mild Bear → Bear and 6 months went Neutral → Mild Bear. Be honest about both — the moves are 0.09 and 0.05 across band boundaries of 1.5 and 0.5 respectively, so these are boundary crossings, not new views. The equal-weight number also crossed zero (+0.02 → -0.04) while staying inside Neutral. A final number this close to zero is not a prediction that nothing happens; it is five forces of real size pulling against each other, which is exactly what the leave-one-out range below is for — and that range still changes sign depending on which single pillar you drop.

COINPICKS MASTER BLEND · ALL FIVE PILLARS EQUAL-WEIGHTED · 20% EACH

Compiled September 26, 2026 (FULL WEEKLY refresh, **DRAFT — awaiting Alex's stamp**) · BTC \$83,918.52 (run.py quant, local refresh, September 26, 2026) · Engine: engine/blend.py — run.py blend (equal-weight, 2026-09-26_draft, draft; last committed set: 2026-09-23_draft) · Not Financial Advice

The Master Table

The whole thesis in five rows, on the September 26 FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-26_draft, **draft**) vs. the Sept 23 committed baseline (2026-09-23_draft). Signals on the -10 to +10 scale.

WINDOW	MASTER (EQUAL- WT)	SEPT 23 (COMMITTED)	THE CALL
1 month	-2.13	-1.95	Bear — weaker. Fed & Macro fell to -3.13 from -2.58 on the week's hawkish bundle, and Iran slipped to -4.61 from -4.51 because every on-record actor now puts a deal past this window; Tokenization easing to +1.01 on its own fired trigger adds to the drag rather than offsetting it
3 months	-1.57	-1.48	Bear — call band flipped from Mild Bear , on a move of 0.09 across the 1.5 boundary. Fed fell hard to -3.40; Iran firmed to -4.68 on the on-record seven-day plan and Tokenization held +2.11, which together absorb most of the Fed cut
6 months	-0.52	-0.48	Mild Bear — call band flipped from Neutral , but the move is 0.05 across the 0.50 boundary, so this is a boundary crossing. Fed fell to -2.05 on the long-run-expectations tick; Iran firmed to -3.58
1 year	+1.19	+1.18	Mild Bull — essentially unchanged. Fed took only -1 and Iran only +1 at this horizon, and the computed TA read ticked up to +1.73, so the window barely moves
3 years	+2.82	+2.82	Bull — unchanged to two decimals. Every pillar still positive, and by design nothing this cycle reached the multi-year windows

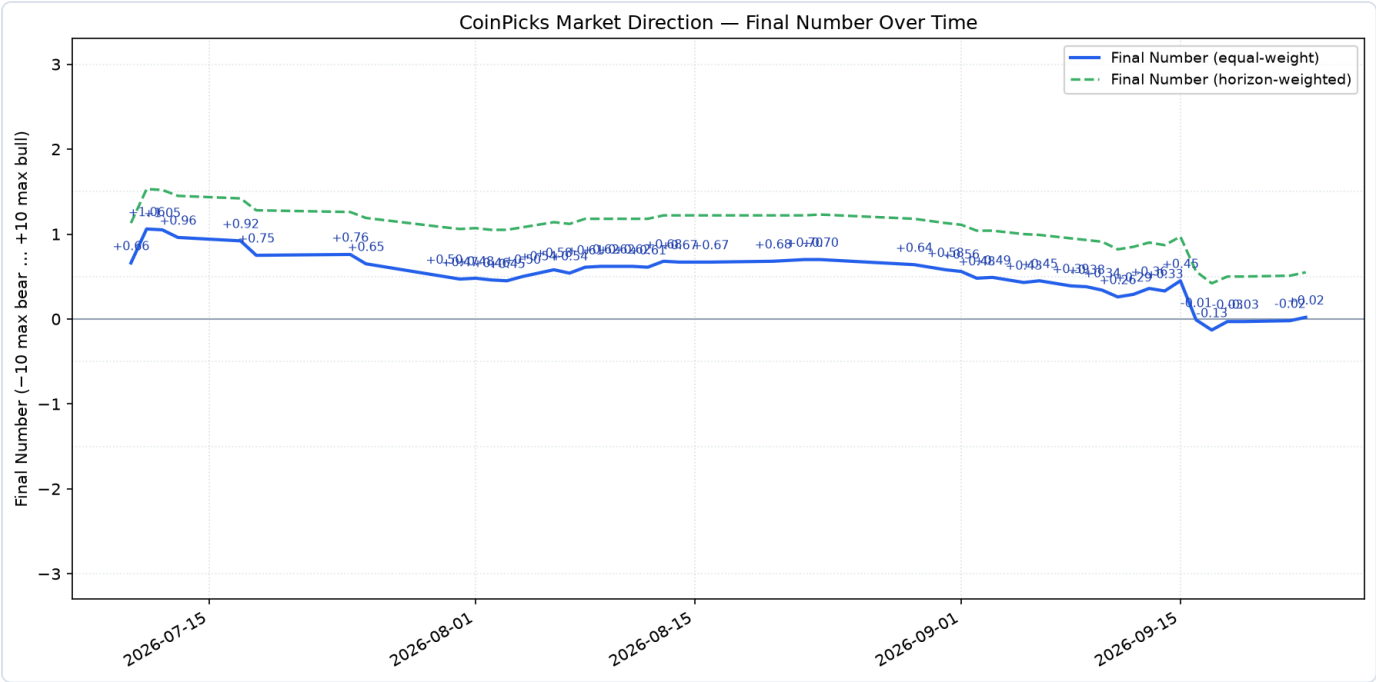
Formula: per pillar, $\text{Signal} = ((P - 50) \div 50) \times \text{Quality} \times \text{Impact}$, with Impact a uniform **8** for every pillar. **MASTER = the simple mean of all five pillar signals** — equal weight, 20% each (add a pillar and it auto-rebalances to 1/N). Bands: $|s| < 0.5$ Neutral · < 1.5 Mild · < 3 Bull/Bear · < 5 Strong · else Very Strong. Machine-verified two ways (hand recompute of every pillar signal and every master window, cross-checked against run.py blend's own output).

THE FINAL NUMBER — HOW IT'S BUILT, AND WHAT MOVED THIS CYCLE

-0.04 = the equal-weight mean of the five MASTER signals above $((-2.13 - 1.57 - 0.52 + 1.19 + 2.82) \div 5)$. Weighting the longer windows harder (10/15/20/30/25%) gives **+0.51**, the same call band as the Sept 23 baseline's +0.55. **What moved:** Fed & Macro was cut four points on 1mo/3mo, three on 6mo and one at 1yr (Barr primary-verified verbatim, the flash PMI's 47-month-high input costs, UMich long-run expectations 3.3% → 3.4%, claims at near-57-year lows, and an \$83.6B one-week reserve drain); Iran War Risk split (1mo -1, 3mo/6mo +2 each, 12mo +1) on Araghchi's on-record seven-day plan against a Nov 3 midterm date; Tokenization was cut one point on 1mo on its own pre-committed tokenized-Treasury trigger; CLARITY held. Fed's cut is the largest single contribution and Iran's split absorbs much of it, which is why the headline moves only 0.06 — and why it is worth saying plainly that a number sitting near zero is not a forecast of "nothing happens," it is offsetting forces of real size.

The Trend — Final Number, Cycle by Cycle

Every committed reading of THE FINAL NUMBER, in sequence — the record of how the call has actually moved, not just where it sits today. (Today's reading joins this history once archived.)



Generated by engine/history.py from every committed master_blend snapshot in reports/archive/. Rebuilt automatically on every run.py archive (or manually via run.py history).

The Full Pillar Matrix

Every pillar's signal on every window — September 26 FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-26_draft), **DRAFT, awaiting Alex's stamp**. Each pillar report shows its own full score lineage.

PILLAR (WEIGHT · IMPACT)	1 MO	3 MO	6 MO	1 YR	3 YR	STATUS
CLARITY Act (20% · 8)	−4.76	−2.99	−0.68	+3.17	+6.38	Held flat at 15/28/45/72/92 — but four fact corrections, incl. one where the report said the OPPOSITE of a primary source. Roll Call 234 verified: cloture failed 49–50 with FOUR Republicans defecting
Iran War Risk (20% · 8)	−4.61	−4.68	−3.58	−1.46	+1.41	RE-RATED as a WINDOW SPLIT to 2/5/18/36/66 — FM Araghchi put a seven-day Hormuz-reopening plan on the record Sept 25 (AP, Reuters, Al Jazeera); the Nov 3 midterms fall outside 1mo, inside 3mo/6mo
Tokenization RWA (20% · 8)	+1.01	+2.11	+2.72	+3.37	+4.03	CUT one point on 1mo to 57/65/70/77/86 — its own pre-committed trigger fired DOWN: tokenized Treasuries \$14.94B, −6.95%/30d, a third consecutive negative. The CFTC's Sept 24 tokenized-collateral FAQ offsets the other windows
Fed & Macro (20% · 8)	−3.13	−3.40	−2.05	−0.84	+0.83	RE-RATED DOWN to 27/25/34/43/58 — Barr's Sept 23 speech verbatim from the Fed's own PDF, the flash PMI's fastest input costs since Oct 2022, UMich long-run expectations 3.3%→3.4%, and reserves −\$83.6B w/w on H.4.1
Bitcoin TA — quant (20% · 8)	+0.84	+1.12	+0.97	+1.73	+1.44	Computed, unchanged methodology: P 57/60/61/68/68, BTC \$83,918.52 (from \$85,488.24). Full local quant refresh this cycle (run.py quant)
MASTER — mean of the five	−2.13	−1.57	−0.52	+1.19	+2.82	Equal weight, 20% each

P lineage (June → Jul 8 → ... → Sept 23 → Sept 26) — CLARITY 55/60/65/85/92 → ... → 15/28/45/72/92 (Sept 16–23, held flat) → **15/28/45/72/92** (Sept 26, held flat). Iran War Risk 50/55/62/75/85 → ... → 1/1/14/33/66 (Sept 16–22) → 3/3/16/35/66 (Sept 23, re-rated up) → **2/5/18/36/66** (Sept 26, window split). Tokenization 53/57/62/72/85 → ... → 58/65/70/77/86 (Sept 18–23, after the SEC-exemption re-rate) → **57/65/70/77/86** (Sept 26, cut one point on 1mo). Fed & Macro 38/40/46/54/61 → ... → 31/29/37/44/58 (Sept 22–23) → **27/25/34/43/58** (Sept 26, re-rated down). Bitcoin TA is computed every run: 58/61/62/67/68 (Sept 23) → **57/60/61/68/68** (Sept 26). The abandoned 2026-09-24_draft is omitted from this lineage because it was never delivered; it remains in config/scores.json permanently. Each pillar report carries its own full, column-by-column lineage table.

The Story, Window by Window

What the blend is saying on September 26, 2026, a FULL WEEKLY refresh (comparisons below are vs. the Sept 23 committed baseline, 2026-09-23_draft)

- **1 month — Bear (−2.13, from −1.95).** Fed & Macro fell to −3.13 from −2.58 on the week's hawkish bundle, and Iran slipped to −4.61 from −4.51 because every on-record actor now places a deal past this window. Tokenization eased to +1.01 on its own fired trigger, so unusually nothing offset the drag here. CLARITY (−4.76), held flat, is still this window's single biggest weight.

- **3 months — Bear (−1.57, from −1.48) — one of two call-band flips this cycle, Mild Bear → Bear.** Named honestly: the window moved 0.09 and 1.5 is the band boundary, so this is a boundary crossing rather than a change of view. Fed fell to −3.40, the largest single pillar move of the cycle; Iran firmed to −4.68 and Tokenization held +2.11, together absorbing most of it.
- **6 months — Mild Bear (−0.52, from −0.48) — the second call-band flip, Neutral → Mild Bear.** The move is 0.05 across a 0.50 boundary. Fed fell to −2.05 on the UMich long-run-expectations tick, while Iran firmed to −3.58 on the on-record seven-day plan.
- **1 year — Mild Bull (+1.19, from +1.18).** Four of five pillars positive: Tokenization +3.37, CLARITY +3.17, Bitcoin TA +1.73, against Iran −1.46 and Fed −0.84. Fed took only −1 and Iran only +1 at this horizon, which is why the window barely moves.
- **3 years — Bull (+2.82, unchanged).** Every pillar still positive: CLARITY +6.38, Tokenization +4.03, Bitcoin TA +1.44, Iran +1.41, Fed +0.83. Nothing this cycle reached the multi-year windows — by design, since none of this week's evidence speaks to 2029.

Where the Two Lenses Agree — and Where They Fight

The point of running qualitative and quantitative on the same standard

THE INDEPENDENT CONFIRMATION

Three qualitative pillars move on fresh research, one holds, and Bitcoin TA (computed) ticks: Fed & Macro was re-rated down on a bundle in which the hard primary data does the work — Governor Barr's Sept 23 speech verbatim from the Fed's own PDF, the S&P Global flash PMI retrieved from the embargoed primary release, UMich's own final September survey, DOL's claims PDF and the Fed's H.4.1. Iran War Risk split by window on Araghchi's on-record seven-day plan against a Nov 3 midterm date. Tokenization was cut on the near window by its own pre-committed tokenized-Treasury trigger. CLARITY Act held flat on the score while four errors in its fact record were corrected. **The moves run in opposite directions and largely cancel**, which is why the headline barely shifts — a near-flat number here reflects offsetting forces, not a quiet market. Worth noting what the verification passes did: they overturned findings in *both* directions, restoring two claims the first-pass research had wrongly "corrected" and falsifying three it had accepted. That is the point of running them.

THE REAL DISAGREEMENT

Near-term: Bitcoin TA (P 57) and Tokenization (P 57) remain the strongest near-term pillars and now sit level with each other; Fed & Macro (P 27) and Iran (P 2, back to the floor) sit far below, and CLARITY (P 15) remains one of the weakest near-term reads. The master resolves it honestly: Bear at 1 month and 3 months, because three pillars drag the same direction at once.

Long-term: the four story pillars average about +3.16 at 3 years (CLARITY +6.38, Tokenization +4.03, Iran +1.41, Fed +0.83) versus the Bitcoin-TA pillar's +1.44 — still roughly 2.2× higher. Remember why: the TA pillar is capped by construction (P never leaves 25–75) and its 3-year Quality is 0.50. Equal weight lets that gap show through honestly instead of burying it in a blend.

Trigger Watch — The Next Six Weeks, Re-Dated

A FULL WEEKLY refresh ran today, researching all four qualitative pillars from primary sources and then adversarially re-verifying the load-bearing claims. Three pillars' triggers fired this cycle. These are the forward triggers; each pillar report carries the full table.

DATE / LEVEL	EVENT	RE-RATES
FIRE Sept 25 — on-record, named principal, 3 independent originals	Iran's FM Abbas Araghchi put a concrete SEVEN-DAY plan on the record outside the UN Security Council, conveyed to Washington via Qatar: ~4–5 days of US steps (lift the naval blockade, waive oil sanctions, release an estimated \$12bn in frozen assets, ceasefire on all fronts), the Strait reopens day six, nuclear talks begin day seven. "The choice now rests with the United States." AP, Reuters and Al Jazeera originals. Araghchi added the US steps "are all already in the MOU"	Iran War Risk: RE-RATED, window split, to 2/5/18/36/66
FIRE Sept 26 — this pillar's OWN pre-committed trigger, fired DOWNWARD	Tokenized US Treasuries contracted for a third consecutive reading: \$14.94B, –6.95% over 30 days (rwa.xyz direct pull) from \$16.00B on Aug 28 — after –0.39% (Aug 22) and –0.93% (Aug 28), at ~7× the prior magnitude. The report had pre-committed that a third negative reading "would be a genuine trend worth re-rating on." Cause unknown and reported as a number, not a narrative; magnitude is single-aggregator	Tokenization: CUT one point on 1mo, to 57/65/70/77/86
FIRE Sept 23–25 — a bundle, mostly PRIMARY	Fed & Macro: Governor Barr's Sept 23 speech, verbatim from the Fed's own PDF — "in my base case, further policy adjustments are likely to be needed"; the S&P Global flash PMI (primary release) pairing the strongest growth since July 2021 with the fastest input-cost inflation since October 2022; UMich final September with long-run inflation expectations breaking a three-month plateau (3.3%→3.4%) and year-ahead 4.0%→4.6%; claims at 197K near 57-year lows; and H.4.1 reserve balances – \$83.6B w/w	Fed & Macro: RE-RATED DOWN to 27/25/34/43/58
Checked Sept 26, no scorable change — but four FACT CORRECTIONS	CLARITY Act: no new floor scheduling and no Democratic yes votes. Corrected against primary sources: the final text DOES require divest-or-blind-trust (the report had said the opposite); TILLIS, not Thune, entered the motion to reconsider; FOUR Republicans defected on Roll Call 234; and a Sept 17 seven-Democrat recommitment statement had been missed by three prior cycles	CLARITY Act: held flat at 15/28/45/72/92
WATCH — Sept 30, 2026 (four days out)	August PCE and the Q2 GDP third estimate (BEA). This is the first HARD inflation print since the three Fed communications above; the Fed pillar's own flip line is only half-met until it lands	Fed & Macro: the real test of this cycle's cut
WATCH — Sept 28 – Oct 2, 2026	The last Senate in-session week before a five-week recess (senate.gov's own 2026 schedule lists "Oct 05 – Nov 06 State Work Period"). No CLARITY re-vote is scheduled; Tillis's motion to reconsider preserves the option but sets no date	CLARITY Act: the only realistic pre-recess window
WATCH — the US response to Iran's seven-day plan	Rubio called the Sept 24 talks "largely positive" but explicitly not a breakthrough. A WSJ report that Trump rejected the plan rests on unnamed officials in one outlet and is NOT scored — no on-record White House position exists as of Sept 26	Iran War Risk: the next concrete signal either way
Oct 27–28, 2026	Next scheduled FOMC meeting. CME FedWatch priced an October hike at ~53% Sept 23, 77.5% Sept 24 and ~70–76% Sept 25 (market prices, not scored); traders price roughly four	Fed & Macro: confirmation or reversal of this cycle's cut

	more hikes by June 2027, which retires this report's earlier "cut by June 2027" row	
~mid-October 2026 at the earliest	First possible live Tokenized Securities Venue under the SEC's temporary conditional exemption (91 FR 60168, published Sept 22). The NYSE Group / Blockchain.com MOU of Sept 23 is real but NON-BINDING, the ATS is not live, and no launch date was disclosed — explicitly not the live-venue trigger	Tokenization: the next genuine upside confirmation
Power-law fair value \$141,272	BTC \$83,918.52 sits ~41% below fair value	1yr/3yr windows: the structural bull case's core, and a reminder that the fit swings with its start year (2011–2015 fits span roughly \$119k–\$146k) — quote it as a range, not a target

The master flip line — two of four Iran clauses remain live, and one has gone dormant: a confirmed new US combat death, a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper, independent confirmation the conflict has widened to a further new state, or a sustained Brent close above \$100. **The Brent clause fired Sept 10–11 and still holds** — Brent closed \$106.60 on Sept 24 (+3.4%, intraday high \$108.23) and \$104.37 on Sept 25, well above \$100. **The strikes clause, which fired Aug 30, is now DORMANT though not un-fired:** no announced US strike on Iranian territory since Sept 1, roughly 3.5 weeks — a negative that rests on ISW's Sept 24 update and the absence of wire reporting, because centcom.mil returned 403, so it is labelled wire-derived rather than primary-verified. **The combat-death clause did NOT fire:** the Pentagon's DCAS total holds at 19 (11 hostile, 8 non-hostile); the 19th, Capt. Bianca C. Wilkerson, posthumously promoted to major, died Sept 18 of a cause DCAS lists as undetermined and which officials describe as a medical incident — explicitly non-hostile. The Sept 23 Hormuz vessel strike caused two casualties, but these were merchant crew, not US service members. **Widening did not fire:** the two Houthis salvos at Saudi Arabia (Sept 24 and overnight Sept 25–26) struck a state already in theatre and were intercepted. **The Iran upside flip line is NOT met:** it requires a signed, US-accepted deal holding a clean week — the US has not accepted, and the Sept 23 vessel strike breaks any clean-week clause. **On CLARITY, the flip line fired on the downside Sept 16** and the lame duck is now the only 2026 path; a renewed cloture vote that actually passes would be the equivalent upside flip. **On Fed & Macro, the flip line is a durable reaction function** — it is now half-met, with three Fed communications confirming the prices-paid re-acceleration but no hard CPI/PCE/PPI print yet; August PCE on Sept 30 is the test. **On Tokenization, the flip line is unchanged from Sept 18** — a live US venue trading under the exemption would be the upside confirmation; the exemption drifting unused toward its five-year sunset, or a rescission during the comment period, would be the downside flip. The TA flip line (weekly close under \$50,000) is unchanged and far from current price.

Robustness — Does Any One Pillar Drive the Call?

Equal weight is now the fixed model — there is no qual/quant mix knob to tune. The test that matters instead: drop any single pillar and see whether the conclusion holds.

— drop CLARITY Act	−0.11	Neutral
— drop Iran War Risk	+0.59	Mild Bull · yes
— drop Tokenization RWA	−0.71	Mild Bear · yes
— drop Fed & Macro	+0.38	Neutral
— drop Bitcoin TA	−0.36	Neutral
all five in (headline)	−0.04	Neutral

Leave-one-out final (drop any one pillar): −0.71 to +0.59 — SIGN STILL FLIPS (fragile), a slightly wider spread than Sept 23’s −0.65 to +0.69. Drop CLARITY −0.11 · drop Iran +0.59 · drop Tokenization −0.71 · drop Fed +0.38 · drop Bitcoin TA −0.36. Read this before you read the headline: with the final number at −0.04, removing any single pillar swings it by far more than the number itself, and the sign is not robust. That is the honest state of the blend, not a footnote to it.

My Decision

**UPDATED DRAFT — SEPTEMBER 26, 2026 (2026-09-26_draft) · FULL WEEKLY REFRESH
· AWAITING MY STAMP · FED CUT · IRAN SPLIT · TOKENIZATION CUT · CLARITY FLAT
· TWO CALL BANDS FLIPPED**

MASTER: -2.13 / -1.57 / -0.52 / +1.19 / +2.82 · THE FINAL NUMBER: -0.04 equal-weight (Neutral) / +0.51 horizon-weighted (Mild Bull) · Leave-one-out range: -0.71 to +0.59 (sign still flips) · Score set 2026-09-26_draft, DRAFT — NOT STAMPED, awaiting Alex's review (full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority) · Last committed set: 2026-09-23_draft, which read +0.02 / +0.55 · Two call bands flipped: 3mo Mild Bear → Bear, 6mo Neutral → Mild Bear · BTC \$83,918.52 (run.py quant, local refresh, September 26, 2026)

This is a **FULL WEEKLY refresh** (2026-09-26_draft) against the Sept 23 committed baseline (2026-09-23_draft): four independent primary-source research passes, one per pillar, then **two adversarial-verification passes that re-derived every load-bearing claim from primary sources rather than from the research's own citations. Three qualitative pillars moved and they largely offset. Fed & Macro** was cut four points on 1mo/3mo, three on 6mo and one at 1yr (31/29/37/44/58 → 27/25/34/43/58). **Iran War Risk** split by window (3/3/16/35/66 → 2/5/18/36/66). **Tokenization** was cut one point on 1mo (58/65/70/77/86 → 57/65/70/77/86), reversing the abandoned Sept 24 draft's nudge in that window. **CLARITY Act held flat** on the score while four errors in its fact record were corrected. The computed Bitcoin TA read ticked with BTC's pullback (\$85,488.24 → \$83,918.52). Two call bands flipped — 3 months Mild Bear → Bear and 6 months Neutral → Mild Bear — both on moves of 0.09 and 0.05 across band boundaries, which is named here rather than dressed up as a change of view.

Housekeeping that matters for trust: this cycle supersedes an interrupted Sept 24 cycle. A 2026-09-24_draft score set and a full set of report edits were written but *never delivered* — no render, no selfcheck, no archive, no commit. Worse, those edits asserted "COMMITTED — SEPTEMBER 24, 2026 · AUTO-STAMPED" in all six decision stamps while config/scores.json was never advanced past draft; run.py selfcheck flagged exactly that, twelve times. Per this system's standing convention for abandoned drafts, it is treated as not-delivered: its claims were independently re-verified rather than trusted, it is dropped from the visible lineage columns, and it stays in scores.json permanently for lineage. **The verdict on it is mixed, and worth stating:** its two Fed claims were *vindicated in full*, its Iran claim was *falsified* on a point of fact (it reported no tanker incidents on Sept 23–24; a vessel was struck Sept 23), and its Tokenization judgement was found *asymmetric* and is reversed.

Why Fed & Macro moved most. Not one headline but a week, and the hard data does the work. PRIMARY: Governor Barr's Sept 23 Chicago Fed speech, all three load-bearing sentences confirmed verbatim by local extraction of the Fed's own PDF — "inflation is above our 2 percent target and not clearly trending toward target in a timely way," "risks to achieving our inflation target have increased, while risks to the labor market have receded," and "in my base case, further policy adjustments are likely to be needed." PRIMARY: the S&P Global flash US PMI, retrieved from the embargoed release — composite 58.4, the strongest private-sector growth since July 2021, paired with the fastest input-cost inflation since October 2022. PRIMARY: UMICH's final September survey, with year-ahead inflation expectations jumping 4.0% → 4.6% and *long-run* expectations ticking 3.3% → 3.4%, breaking three straight months — de-anchoring is what extends a tightening cycle past one meeting, and it is why 6mo took -3 rather than the abandoned draft's -1. PRIMARY: DOL claims at 197,000, near 57-year lows, removing the last dovish counterweight; and H.4.1 reserve balances down \$83,601M in a single week, the largest drain this report has logged. **Two sourcing honesty notes:** NY Fed President Williams was *characterising investors' forecasts* when he called another year-end hike likely, and hedged it with "but we have to see" — presenting that as his own flat assertion would be exactly the market-expectation-versus-official-estimate conflation this system forbids; and Boston Fed President Collins's inflation-risk warning, though quoted correctly, traces entirely to one Reuters story, so it is effectively single-agency. Both are used as corroboration only. **The honest other side:** growth is strong, layoffs are near 57-year lows, August

new home sales *rose*, the Fed's own SCOOS shows credit terms basically unchanged, and the big reserve drain is largely a mechanical TGA rebuild — which is why the move is single-digit and stops at 12mo.

Why Iran War Risk split rather than moved one way. The scorable change is an upgrade in *evidence quality*: the diplomatic track went from anonymous sourcing to named principals on the record. FM Araghchi, outside the UN Security Council on Sept 25, detailed a seven-day plan conveyed via Qatar — US steps over ~4–5 days (lift the blockade, waive oil sanctions, release an estimated \$12bn in frozen assets, ceasefire on all fronts), the Strait reopening on day six, nuclear talks on day seven — carried by AP, Reuters and Al Jazeera as independent originals. Pezeshkian, in a CBS excerpt released Sept 25 ahead of the Sunday broadcast, said Iran would “abide by whatever we commit to” and would readmit UN nuclear inspectors, though explicitly *conditional* on US acceptance. The midterms are Nov 3, which falls outside the 1mo window and inside 3mo and 6mo — so 1mo goes down a point while 3mo and 6mo go up two each, sized on the Sept 13/Sept 22 announced-meeting precedent. **The counterweight is why the up-move is small: the up-move rests on statements while the confirmed actions run the other way.** A cargo vessel was struck in Hormuz on Sept 23 with two casualties; Houthi forces fired on Saudi Arabia twice; the blockade is intact; Hormuz traffic shows no recovery at roughly 9–18 transits a day against a ~125/day pre-war baseline; and Brent is back above \$100.

Why Tokenization was cut, against the grain of its own good news. This pillar's trigger table had pre-committed, in its own words, that “a third consecutive negative reading would be a genuine trend worth re-rating on.” It got one: tokenized US Treasuries read \$14.94B, down 6.95% over 30 days from \$16.00B, after -0.39% and -0.93% — roughly seven times the prior magnitude. Acting on a trigger the report itself wrote down is the whole point of writing it down, so 1mo takes -1. The abandoned Sept 24 draft took +1 here on the NYSE Group / Blockchain.com MOU while not accounting for the contraction, which is asymmetric: the MOU is real and independently verified, but it is non-binding, “subject to any required regulatory approvals,” the ATS is not live, no launch date was disclosed, and this pillar's own standard names “an actual live venue announcement” as the trigger. The other four windows hold because two genuine positives offset the contraction — chiefly the CFTC's Sept 24 FAQ update (primary, PDF extracted locally), whose new Q12 lets an FCM or DCO hold *tokenized* Regulation 1.25 collateral, opening an institutional demand channel aimed squarely at the product whose flow just fell, and whose Q15 contemplates *public and permissionless* chains for regulatory recordkeeping. Both are staff no-objection guidance rather than rules, so they are logged, not scored.

Why CLARITY held flat, and what got corrected anyway. No development cleared the sufficiency bar: no floor scheduling, no Democratic yes votes, and senate.gov's own schedule confirms one session week (Sept 28 – Oct 2) before a five-week recess, with no re-vote set. But the fact record needed four fixes, and one was serious: **the report stated the opposite of a primary source**, claiming the final text “does not require divestment or blind-trust placement.” Senator Lummis's own summary of the final text says verbatim there is a “clear requirement for covered individuals to divest significant financial interests or place in a qualified blind trust.” The honest framing is *real but delayed* — effective 360 days after enactment or 60 days after the section 10102 final rule, whichever is sooner. Also corrected: the stablecoin-yield fight is *not* unresolved (the text carries a Treasury circuit breaker whose authority expires 18 months after enactment); **Tillis**, not Thune, entered the motion to reconsider; and the report never mentioned that **four Republicans defected** on Roll Call 234 (Collins, Hawley, Moran, Tillis), which is a harder read than framing the failure as purely Democratic. A Sept 17 joint statement by seven Democratic negotiators recommitting to the bill had also been missed by three consecutive prior cycles, including a full weekly. The score still holds because the two items that clear the bar cut in opposite directions and both are embedded in the 49–50 failure already priced here.

What was deliberately NOT scored, in either direction. The sufficiency rule did real work this cycle. Against the Iran up-move: a WSJ report that Trump *rejected* the seven-day plan and expects to resume bombing after the midterms — unnamed officials, one outlet, every other outlet citing WSJ, no on-record White House position. Also not scored: The National's 60-day “road map” (still single-original-source, and a different frame from Araghchi's seven-day plan — the two are not merged); the Pentagon's 19th US death (non-hostile, DCAS cause undetermined, so the combat-death flip line does not fire); a White House adviser's remark that the lame duck “is not a significant focus” (effectively single-source, and bearish); prediction-market odds on CLARITY (6.45% on Polymarket, on \$12.7k of daily volume — an illiquid, effectively dead market) and on the midterms, which are market prices in a single outlet and barred on both counts; and Ondo's BlackRock-strategy portfolios, live Sept 24 but restricted to non-US investors, the same ground on which Robinhood Chain and Coinbase's Base launch were both previously excluded. **A**

methodology finding worth carrying forward: on PDFs and very large text files, the automated fetch layer fails silently in *both* directions — it reported a real Barr sentence as absent, and separately reported 10-year-yield figures that the source does not contain. Verbatim PDF quotes in this system now require local text extraction; that alone justifies keeping the adversarial pass in every weekly refresh.

Stamp decision: LEFT AS DRAFT — NOT auto-stamped — awaiting Alex's review. The governing reason is categorical: this is a **full weekly refresh**, which CLAUDE.md's delegated auto-stamp authority excludes independent of move size, call-band flips or evidence quality, because the weekly is Alex's own periodic review checkpoint. Two further facts reinforce that outcome rather than substituting for it: this cycle corrected four factual errors in a delivered report, and it cleaned up an interrupted cycle whose reports claimed a stamp that was never written. Research capability was *not* degraded — primary fetches succeeded across federalreserve.gov, dol.gov, treasury.gov, the UMich survey, the S&P Global release, senate.gov, lummis.senate.gov, cftc.gov, the Federal Register API and rwa.xyz. Status: draft, stamped_by: null.

For Alex, before stamping — the three things I would want a second opinion on: (1) two facts could not be primary-verified because their sources block automated access — the Sept 23 Hormuz vessel strike (ukmto.org 403, so wire-derived) and the "no US strike since Sept 1" negative (centcom.mil 403, so ISW/wire-derived); neither drives a P move by itself. (2) The tokenized-Treasury -6.95% magnitude is single-aggregator — corroborated in direction and rough level by an independent Sept 15 citation of ~\$15.9B, but no second aggregator reproduces the exact figure, and its cause is genuinely unknown. (3) August PCE lands Sept 30, four days out, and is the first hard test of the Fed cut taken here; if it comes in soft, this cycle's largest move is the one to revisit first.

What to watch next, in order: (1) August PCE and the Q2 GDP third estimate on Sept 30 — the first hard data on the Fed re-rate; (2) whether the US responds on the record to Iran's seven-day plan, and whether the WSJ's anonymous rejection account is ever confirmed or denied by a named official; (3) whether any Tokenized Securities Venue actually goes live under the SEC exemption, and whether the tokenized-Treasury contraction continues into a fourth reading; (4) whether the Fed delivers the further hike its own SEP median projects at the Oct 27–28 FOMC; (5) whether anything moves on CLARITY in the Sept 28 – Oct 2 week, the last before a five-week recess.

Read as an investment posture: the near windows are Bear and got modestly worse, the one-year window is still Mild Bull, and the headline sits at -0.04 — essentially flat, having crossed zero without changing call band. This is not a month to chase. Read the robustness table before the headline: dropping Tokenization alone puts the reading at -0.71 (Mild Bear) while dropping Iran puts it at +0.59 (Mild Bull), so the leave-one-out range still straddles zero and the sign is not robust. That fragility is the honest state of the blend, and it is the reason this number is published with its workings rather than on its own.

Sources

Each pillar report carries its full, freshly-checked source list. The master adds the engine and headline references for this September 23 LIGHT DAILY touch.

- **The pillars:** the sibling reports in this folder — CoinPicks_CLARITY_Act / Iran_War / Tokenization_RWA (carried forward unchanged this cycle, not re-researched) / Fed_Macro Pillar Reports (independently re-researched and re-rated this cycle, see that report's own What Changed and Sources) and the computed Bitcoin TA Quant Pillar Report.
- **The engine:** engine/blend.py → data/master_blend.json (score set 2026-09-23_draft in config/scores.json, status: committed, active_qual_set; prior committed set 2026-09-22_draft; full lineage back to 2026-06-19_committed; final-number window weights in config/settings.json "final_weights") · engine/mapping.py → data/pillar_scores.json (data through Sept 23, 2026).
- **September 23 light daily touch — the load-bearing facts checked this cycle:** Reuters (primary wire, Sept 22, Iranian official's Hormuz-reopening offer) plus Washington Times, Yahoo, US News, The Star, Israel Hayom, KFGO, BOE Report, AOL (8+ corroborating outlets) · Al Jazeera, Axios, The Hill, Times of Israel, New Arab, Al Arabiya (6+ independent outlets on the Sept 22 UNGA-sidelines US-Iran meeting) plus Iranian state media confirmation.
- **September 22 light daily touch — the load-bearing facts checked that cycle:** philadelphiafed.org (primary, Philadelphia Fed Manufacturing Business Outlook Survey released Sept 17) plus MarketScreener, NAM, investinglive, Kitco, Bitget, Academic Capital (5+ corroborating outlets) · newyorkfed.org (primary, fetched directly, New York Fed Empire State Manufacturing Survey released Sept 15).

- **Carried forward from the September 19 full weekly refresh, not re-checked this cycle:** Roll Call, BGov, The Well News, Troutman Financial Services (Senate 2026 calendar) · The Block, Yahoo Finance/247WallSt, CryptoTimes, Gokhshtein (Sept 18, CFTC's Sept 17 OIRA filing, RIN 3038-AF80) · Axios, Jerusalem Post, Politico/Political Wire, Israel National News, Breitbart (Sept 17, Trump's Iran remark) · UN press releases (press.un.org), Euronews, Security Council Report (Sept 17, UNSC veto) · IRNA/GlobalSecurity.org, The Hill, Bernama, IranWire (Sept 17-18, "Trend" tanker corroboration) · SEC.gov press release 2026-90 and Commissioner Uyeda statement (primary, Sept 17), CNBC, Coindesk, Crowdfund Insider, Decrypt, Securities.io (exemption mechanics) · SIFMA.org (primary, pushback statement) · U.S. Dept of Labor, Census Bureau/HUD, NAR, University of Michigan Surveys of Consumers (primary, labor/housing/sentiment data) · CNBC, CNN, NBC News, Bloomberg, The Hill (Trump-vs-Fed political-pressure story).
- **Price:** BTC/USD \$83,918.52 (Sept 24, 2026, data/btc_usd_daily.csv via a local run.py quant refresh) — down from \$85,488.24 (Sept 23); cycle low \$58,526 (2026-06-30), cycle top \$124,728 (2025-10-06).